SCOTTISH SHORTBREAD

YIELD	OVEN	ENERGY COST
12-16 pieces	**375F, 15-30 min**	**$2.06 (30 min bake plus 30 min, 3.5 kW at 59 cents/kWh)**

INGREDIENTS

225 g	Salted butter, softened
100 g	Granulated sugar
310 g	All-purpose flour
1/2 tsp	Sugar, for sprinkling on top

METHOD

1. Mix the butter and sugar together but do NOT cream them. Amalgamate only, a few minutes, until it looks like sandy crumbs.
2. Add the flour and mix to a stiff consistency. Stop as soon as it comes together.
3. Roll out on a lightly floured surface to the shape of the pan.
4. Transfer to a lightly greased 8x8 pan or a sheet, trim the edges. For fingers, keep the dough no thinner than 3/4 inch (2 cm) and cut strips wide enough to take a fork prick.
5. Prick about halfway through with a fork.
6. Bake at 375F for 15 to 30 minutes depending on thickness and shape, only very slightly browned at the edges. It should not go dark.
7. Sprinkle the sugar over the moment it leaves the oven, then cool in the pan before moving.

NOTES

Three ingredients in the dough, and the refusal to cream is the entire technique. Creaming aerates, which is wrong for this texture.
Highest oven of the shortbreads at 375F, yet the target is pale, so watch it rather than trusting the clock.
Nothing to hide behind, so butter quality decides the result.
Weigh rather than measure by cup.
Keeps for weeks in a sealed tin and freezes well.

DATE ____ / ____ / ____ RATING ____ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

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